ANDREW STRACHAN

M.S. Cybersecurity Candidate | SFS CyberAICorps Scholarship Recipient | UAB

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate student and software builder with experience in secure web services, on-device AI, compliance operations and technical teaching. Builds practical tools, tests releases and translates technical work for students and colleagues.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Python Coding Summer Camp Teaching Assistant

University of Alabama at Birmingham (UAB), Birmingham, AL | 06/2026 - 07/2026

• Taught middle-school Python through micro:bit and drone projects; supported summer orientation.

Founder & Technologist

MaQkrs Consulting, Birmingham, AL | 01/2022 - Present

• Built a secure TypeScript/Express backend for an Atlanta client, with access controls, automated security tests and an incident-response drill.

• Built client sites for Legacy Meadows and Victorious Herbal Elements; worked with **student testers** on MaQkrs AI Tutor beta builds.

Career and Technical Education (CTE) Teacher

Shades Valley High School, Birmingham, AL | 07/2024 - 06/2025

• Won the 2025 Jefferson County Board of Education Technology Torchbearer Award for Excellence for website building, 3D printing and student-built fundraiser apps.

• Advised Future Business Leaders of America (FBLA); coached esports and helped start the media team, coordinating photoshoots, video setup and student projects.

CTE Teacher; Founding DECA Adviser

Corner High School, Dora, AL | 08/2023 - 06/2024

• Founded DECA; students placed first and second at the 2024 Alabama conference. Taught Sports & Entertainment Marketing through student-led sports posts and flyers.

Operations Director

MidSouth Extracts LLC, Tupelo, MS | 01/2023 - 05/2023

• Ran a Mississippi State Department of Health (MSDH)-licensed medical cannabis processing facility; secured processor and manufactured-food approvals.

• Wrote 11 standard operating procedures (SOPs) and a Hazard Analysis and Critical Control Points (HACCP) plan; MSDH gave "A+" feedback.

Consultant

Lampton & Worm, Mississippi | 11/2022 - 12/2022

• Drafted MidSouth license-application chapters and procedures, leading to the Operations Director role.

Sales Development Specialist; Team Lead

SelectQuote Insurance Services, Clinton, MS | 10/2021 - 11/2022

• Built new-representative training as Sales Development Specialist (04/2022 - 11/2022), addressing knowledge gaps and reducing complaints.

• Team Lead (10/2021 - 03/2022); Team Lead and Top Sales Awards (2021). Promoted from Insurance Sales Representative (04/2021 - 09/2021; 40 hours/week).

CERTIFICATIONS & COMPETITIONS

• **DragonByte Cyber Club, UAB** (01/2026 - Present): wrote 25% of challenges for the first UAB capture-the-flag (CTF) contest for Alabama middle-school students (04/2026).

• **Alabama High School Programming Contest, UAB** (09/2026): coordinated teams, student activities and teacher communication; Certificate of Appreciation.

• **Microsoft Certified Educator**, 05/2025; 14 Google Cloud skill badges, 2024-2025; Alabama emergency teaching certificate (2023).

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER SERVICE

- **Chair, Opioid Crisis Council** (2018), University of Mississippi Medical Center (UMMC) and Mississippi Bureau of Narcotics: convened about 27 university and state leaders.
- **President & Founder, Peer-Assisted Learning Society**, UMMC (2017); **Virginia Covington Award (2018)**, recognizing a role-model medical student.
- **Event Coordinator (Volunteer), UAB Computer Science International Food Festival** (04/2026): one of three coordinators for about 45 attendees.
- **Assistant Youth Leader (Volunteer)**, Gulfport, MS (08/2011 - Present; about 1-2 hours/week, seasonal): led overnight trips for 30+ youth.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

- **Personal Agentic Citadel:** Java gateway for artificial intelligence (AI) agents: rate limits, schema-locked tools, allowlisted file writes and no browser key. Private repository; demo on request.
- **MaQkrs AI Tutor (pre-release beta):** built an on-device SwiftUI study app using Apple models and Gemma via MLX Swift; SHA-256-verified model downloads. Presented at UAB, 04/2026.
- **Blockchain (CS 646):** led quality assurance for a five-person Python team; signed transactions, Transmission Control Protocol gossip, continuous integration and release packaging.
- **Secure cloud file sharing (CS 633):** private Amazon Web Services storage, per-recipient signed links and deletion after all recipients download; demo video.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Security:** Wireshark, Nmap, threat modeling, zero-trust access control, vulnerability scanning; computer forensics coursework.
- **Software and cloud:** Python, C, Java, Swift/SwiftUI, TypeScript, SQL, GitHub Actions, Terraform; Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud, Firebase; Linux.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- **ESL professional development**, Jefferson County Board of Education, 2024-2025; **Google Cloud Trusted Tester (Veo 2)**, 2025.

EDUCATION

University of Alabama at Birmingham (UAB)
Birmingham, AL | 01/2026 - Expected 12/2027

- Master of Science, Cybersecurity; Cyber Crime Investigation concentration; full-time; GPA 3.75.
- **NSA Center of Academic Excellence in Cyber Research (CAE-R).**
- Completed: Object-Oriented Programming, Systems Programming, Networking; Network Security, Cloud Computing.
- Current (Fall 2026): Computer Forensics, Computer Security, Blockchain and Cryptocurrency.

University of Montevallo
Montevallo, AL | 08/2024 - 05/2025

- Non-degree coursework toward an Alabama teaching certificate; GPA 3.66.
- Field: Business, Marketing, and Finance.

University of Mississippi School of Medicine
Jackson, MS | 2016 - 2020

- Medical Studies, Course and clinical work.

Mississippi College
Clinton, MS | 08/2011 - 05/2016

- B.S. double major: American Chemical Society-certified Biochemistry and Biological Medical Sciences.
- Music minor; cum laude; GPA 3.50.
- Alpha Epsilon Delta, member 2014-2015; Delta Epsilon Iota; Phi Mu Alpha; Senior Class Senator.